

ABD EL FATTAH ALI ELEWA

Senior Refinery Operations & Commissioning Specialist | CDU & VRU Operations | Shift In-Charge



Egypt

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PROFILE

Operations and Commissioning professional with more than 20 years of experience in refinery, petrochemical, and oil & gas operations. Experienced in CDU (Crude Distillation Unit), Vapor Recovery Unit (VRU), Gas Sweetening Unit (GSU), LPG Treating Systems, utilities, and refinery startup operations. Worked in major refinery expansion and startup projects with strong involvement in pre-commissioning, commissioning, startup, shutdown, troubleshooting, and day-to-day plant operations. Experienced in both control room and field operations with good understanding of refinery processes, plant safety, and operational coordination. Skilled in operating and monitoring process systems through DCS and SCADA platforms including Yokogawa, Emerson DeltaV, Honeywell, Foxboro, Schneider Electric, and Rockwell Automation systems.

PROFESSIONAL STRENGTHS

- Refinery Operations
- Commissioning & Startup
- CDU Operations
- VRU Operations
- GSU Operations
- LPG & Fuel Gas Systems
- DCS & SCADA Operations
- Process Troubleshooting
- Operational Readiness
- Utilities & Offsite Operations
- Process Safety & HSSE
- Permit to Work (PTW)
- Emergency Response
- Refinery Expansion Projects

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Operations & Maintenance Manager

EPRM – Petrosannan Oil & Gas Production | Western Desert, Egypt Jun 2025 – Present

- Supervise daily operations and maintenance activities for oil & gas production facilities.
- Monitor plant performance and support safe and reliable operation.
- Coordinate with maintenance, engineering, and operations teams.
- Support troubleshooting and operational improvement activities.

Assistant Operations Manager – Pre-Commissioning, Commissioning & Startup

EPRM / PETROJET – NPC CDU-4 & VRU-3 Project Jan 2022 – Jun 2025

- Participated in pre-commissioning, commissioning, and startup activities for CDU-4 and VRU-3 refinery units.
- Coordinated flushing, leak testing, drying, line-up, and system turnover activities.

- Monitored process systems through DCS and SCADA during startup activities.
- Participated in loop checks, functional testing, and troubleshooting activities.

CDU (Crude Distillation Unit) Responsibilities

The CDU is the primary refinery unit where crude oil is separated into different hydrocarbon fractions.

Main Responsibilities

- Operate and monitor crude distillation processes safely and efficiently.
- Control temperatures, pressures, flow rates, and furnace operations.
- Monitor desalting operations and crude feed quality.
- Maintain stable fractionation and product specifications.
- Coordinate startup, shutdown, and unit changeover activities.
- Monitor overhead systems, reflux, stripping steam, and heat exchangers.
- Ensure stable operation of pumps, compressors, and furnace systems.
- Respond to process alarms and abnormal operating conditions.
- Coordinate with field operators and maintenance teams.
- Ensure compliance with HSSE and process safety procedures.

Main Products

- LPG
 - Naphtha
 - Kerosene
 - Diesel
 - Atmospheric Gas Oil
 - Residue
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VRU (Vapor Recovery Unit) Responsibilities

The VRU recovers hydrocarbon vapors from storage tanks, loading systems, and process vents to reduce emissions and recover valuable hydrocarbons.

Main Responsibilities

- Operate and monitor vapor recovery compressors and recovery systems.
 - Control pressure, vacuum, and vapor flow within operating limits.
 - Recover VOCs (Volatile Organic Compounds) and hydrocarbon vapors.
 - Minimize flaring and atmospheric emissions.
 - Monitor condensers, absorbers, separators, and recovery equipment.
 - Coordinate startup, shutdown, and maintenance activities.
 - Troubleshoot compressor trips, pressure fluctuations, and vapor leaks.
 - Ensure environmental compliance and emission control standards.
 - Monitor SCADA/DCS systems and process alarms.
 - Support refinery flare and fuel gas balancing activities.
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GSU Responsibilities

In oil & gas operations, GSU commonly means:

Gas Sweetening Unit

The unit removes acid gases such as H₂S and CO₂ from natural gas or refinery gas streams.

Main Responsibilities

- Operate amine treating and gas sweetening systems.
- Monitor absorber and regenerator tower performance.
- Control amine circulation, temperature, pressure, and gas quality.
- Monitor H₂S and CO₂ removal efficiency.
- Maintain gas quality according to plant specifications.
- Monitor reboilers, heat exchangers, filters, and pumps.
- Troubleshoot foaming, corrosion, contamination, and carryover problems.
- Ensure safe handling of sour gas systems.

- Coordinate with sulfur recovery or flare systems.
- Maintain compliance with process safety and environmental regulations.

LPG Unit Responsibilities

The LPG Unit handles production, treatment, storage, and transfer of Liquefied Petroleum Gas.

Main Responsibilities

- Operate LPG treating, storage, and transfer systems safely.
- Monitor LPG pressure, temperature, composition, and product quality.
- Control compressors, pumps, vessels, and treating systems.
- Monitor mercaptan removal and sulfur specifications.
- Coordinate LPG loading and offloading operations.
- Ensure safe operation of LPG bullets, tanks, and transfer lines.
- Respond to gas leaks, pressure alarms, and emergency situations.
- Support startup, shutdown, and maintenance activities.
- Ensure compliance with fire and gas safety procedures.
- Maintain operational coordination with CDU and fuel gas systems.

Operations, Commissioning & Startup Supervisor

EPROM – MIDOR Refinery Expansion Project | Alexandria Free Zone, Egypt Jul 2008 – Jan 2022

- Supervised commissioning and startup activities for refinery process and utility systems.
- Operated and monitored refinery systems using DCS and SCADA platforms.
- Participated in troubleshooting, shutdown, and startup stabilization activities.

Control Operator

Alexandria Fiber Company (AFCO) – Aditya Birla Group Sep 2004 – Jul 2008

- Operated polymer and solvent recovery units using DCS systems.
- Monitored process alarms and operational conditions.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Process & Operations

CDU Operations, VRU Operations, GSU Operations, LPG Treating Systems, Fuel Gas Systems, Utilities Operations, Startup & Shutdown, Process Troubleshooting, Process Monitoring, Operational Readiness.

Control & Automation

Yokogawa CENTUM VP / CS3000, Emerson DeltaV, Honeywell DCS, Foxboro Systems, Schneider Electric Systems, Rockwell Automation FactoryTalk View SE, PLC & SCADA Systems.

HSE & SAFETY

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Process Safety Management (PSM) • HSSE Procedures • Permit to Work (PTW) | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Risk Assessment • Emergency Response • Safety Procedures & Compliance |
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EDUCATION

PhD – Environmental Sciences

2025 | Excellent Grade

Research Topic: Activated Carbon Production from Agro-Waste for Wastewater Treatment

Master's Degree – Environmental Sciences

2017 | Excellent Grade

Research Topic: Environmental impact

B.Sc. Chemistry

Alexandria University – 2004 | Honor Degree

LANGUAGES

- Arabic — Native
- English — Good Working Proficiency